

Anees Shaik

DevSecOps & Cloud Platform Leader

(845) 464-3353 • anees.shaik9@gmail.com • Washington D.C. Metro Area

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior engineering leader with 10+ years of experience building and scaling secure, compliant cloud platforms across AWS and Azure. Proven record of leading high-performing teams, modernizing legacy infrastructure, reducing risk and cost, and aligning engineering strategy with business and regulatory objectives. Deep expertise in DevSecOps, cloud security, CI/CD, NIST-aligned controls, and platform engineering in regulated environments.

LEADERSHIP & WORK EXPERIENCE

CSSI LLC | Washington, D.C.

Principal DevSecOps Architect Aug 2024 – Present

- Own enterprise DevSecOps and cloud platform strategy across AWS and Azure, supporting 15+ production applications operating in regulated environments.
- Lead and develop a cross-functional organization of 8 engineers spanning DevOps, cloud, security, and application engineering.
- Establish engineering standards for risk detection, vulnerability management, remediation workflows, audit logging, and evidence collection, improving platform stability by ~40% and reducing repeat findings.
- Drive cloud modernization initiatives including application re-architecture, security hardening, encryption standards, and cost optimization, reducing cloud spend by ~25% while improving reliability and compliance posture.
- Partner with GRC, SOC, Audit, Product, and Executive leadership to translate FISMA, FedRAMP, and NIST 800-53 compliance requirements into technical controls, platform capabilities, and delivery roadmaps.
- Ensure security best practices—encryption at rest/in transit, access controls, audit logging, and least-privilege enforcement—are embedded as default platform capabilities, not manual processes.
- Translate regulatory and security requirements into policy-as-code, CI/CD guardrails, and continuous compliance checks, reducing manual audit effort and operational friction.
- Balance delivery, reliability, and security through capacity planning, prioritization, and technical debt management across the platform.
- Advocate for platform and security investment by translating technical risk into business impact, improving delivery velocity and cost efficiency.
- Serve on the organization's AI Governance Committee, contributing to responsible AI adoption policies, standards, and risk management practices across the enterprise.
- Lead review of existing contracts and applications to identify and recommend opportunities where AI capabilities can enhance customer and client experience, driving measurable operational improvements.
- Establish AI guardrails, governance frameworks, and acceptable-use standards for all teams leveraging AI tools within the organization, ensuring responsible and compliant adoption.
- Contribute to the proposal drafting team for new contract bids, translating technical capabilities, platform expertise, and past performance into compelling, competitive proposals.

//**Tools & Technologies:** AWS, Azure, VMware, GitHub, KMS/HSM, SIEM, Policy-as-Code, NIST 800-53, FISMA, FedRAMP, Copilot, Gemini, Claude, FIPS 199, DISA-STI

Senior Engineering Manager Feb 2022 – Jul 2024

- Led migration of 10+ on-prem applications to AWS, defining cloud architecture, security controls, audit logging, and compliance requirements; reduced on-prem footprint by ~80% and improved stability by ~35%.
- Defined the cloud security platform architecture for multi-account AWS and Azure environments, enabling standardized security controls at scale.
- Researched and implemented cloud security best practices including encryption, identity and access controls, audit logging, and network segmentation to meet compliance and organizational security standards.
- Designed a secure-by-default CI/CD platform embedding automated security testing, policy enforcement, and supply-chain protections aligned with NIST-based security baselines.
- Implemented CI/CD pipelines using GitHub Actions, automating testing and deployment workflows and reducing release cycles significantly.
- Built centralized security and compliance control frameworks using Infrastructure-as-Code and policy-as-code to enforce guardrails and automatically generate audit evidence.

- Architected enterprise key management and secrets platforms using cloud KMS and HSMs to support encryption, rotation, logging, and auditability.
- Collaborated with Product, Security, and Application teams to define technical specifications for new security features, translating requirements into scalable backend solutions.
- Integrated security tooling (Splunk, Tanium, CyberArk, Nessus, WebInspect, DbProtect) to deliver unified monitoring, endpoint visibility, privileged access control, and vulnerability management.
- Established structured vulnerability remediation workflows and SLAs, reducing backlog by ~35% and recurring critical issues by ~20%.
- Maintained comprehensive architecture diagrams, deployment documentation, and incident response playbooks to support operational excellence, audits, and onboarding.
- Influenced product and infrastructure roadmaps by translating security and compliance risk into scalable architectural solutions.

//**Tools & Technologies:** AWS, Azure, VMware, GitHub, Splunk, Tanium, CyberArk, Nessus, WebInspect, DbProtect, KMS/HSM, NIST 800-53, FISMA, FedRAMP

Senior DevOps Engineer Feb 2020 – Feb 2022

- Embedded security into CI/CD pipelines across AWS and Azure, reducing production vulnerabilities by ~80q%.
- Implemented CI/CD pipelines using Azure Pipelines and GitHub Actions, automating testing and deployment workflows and improving release cycles by ~50%.
- Researched and implemented cloud security best practices including encryption, access controls, and audit logging to meet organizational security and compliance standards.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to define technical specifications for security enhancements, translating requirements into reliable backend and infrastructure solutions.
- Established standards for secure coding, branching strategies, design reviews, and release governance, reducing deployment issues by ~30%.
- Defined technical direction for platform upgrades to Windows Server 2022 and RHEL 9, reducing reliance on legacy systems by 50%+.
- Designed disaster recovery strategies with defined RPO/RTO targets, reducing recovery time by ~60%.
- Standardized backup and retention policies across environments, achieving ~99% backup reliability from 30%.
- Authored and maintained system architecture documentation, deployment runbooks, and incident response procedures to support operations and on-call readiness.

//**Tools & Technologies:** AWS, Azure, GitHub Actions, Ansible, Terraform, Azure Pipelines, Windows Server, RHEL, CI/CD, Backup & DR Tooling

Gannett Co. | Tysons Corner, VA

Senior DevOps Engineer Feb 2017 – Feb 2020

- Part of a 16-person platform engineering team responsible for designing and operating automation pipelines, infrastructure provisioning, and quality engineering for the entire organization.
- Built and maintained CI/CD pipelines and infrastructure automation supporting an in-house CMS that hosted and sourced content for 100+ publications across the USA, serving millions of daily readers.
- Co-architected and built a model-based regression testing framework against the in-house CMS, enabling automated nightly test execution to detect defects in user functionality before releases reached production.
- Championed a shift-left testing strategy across the engineering organization, embedding automated testing earlier in the development lifecycle and significantly reducing bug escape rate, rework cost, and time-to-release.
- Owned health check monitoring and observability across platform services, implementing Grafana dashboards to provide real-time visibility into application and infrastructure performance.
- Automated cloud infrastructure provisioning using Terraform and Docker, improving environment consistency and reducing manual setup overhead across teams.
- Designed and executed visual regression testing using Applitools and cross-browser/device regression suites via Sauce Labs, ensuring consistent UI quality across all publication properties.

Tools & Technologies: Jenkins, Terraform, Docker, Kubernetes, Selenium, pytest, Appium, Applitools, Sauce Labs, Grafana, AWS, Linux

Earlier Experience

Data Migration Engineer — International Food Policy Research Institute, Washington D.C. (Nov 2016 – Jan 2017)

DevOps Engineer — REAN Cloud (AWS Partner), Herndon, VA (Apr 2016 – Sep 2016)

Focused on AWS migrations, infrastructure automation, encryption, and deployment standardization.

EDUCATION

State University of New York, New Paltz 2014 – 2015

Master of Science in Computer Science

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified AI Practitioner
- Google Cloud Certified AI Practitioner
- AWS Certified Developer – Associate
- AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner

KEY SKILLS & STRENGTHS

• Engineering leadership, coaching & mentorship • Performance management & career development • Technical roadmap planning • Cross-functional collaboration & stakeholder alignment • Cloud Architecture (AWS, Azure) • DevSecOps Strategy & Governance • Infrastructure as Code (Terraform, CloudFormation) • CI/CD Automation (Jenkins, GitHub Actions, Azure Pipelines)	• NIST 800-53, FISMA, FedRAMP-influenced controls • Vulnerability management & security tooling • Key management, encryption & secrets (KMS/HSM) • SRE & operational excellence • Docker, Kubernetes • Python, JavaScript, Ruby • AI/ML integration & automation frameworks • SQL & NoSQL systems
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ACHIEVEMENTS & RECOGNITION

- CSSI Leadership Award 2025
- CSSI Best Team Award 2023
- CSSI Rookie of the Year 2021
- Gannett Best team award 2018
- IBM Student Ambassador 2014
- Microsoft Student Partner (2012–2014)
- Led student engineering teams across multiple academic projects
- Head of Documentation & Public Relations, University Technical Fest